

THE ACCUSER AND THE ACCUSED

In the crosshairs are a senior cop close to the CMO and CM's political secretary



P.V. Anvar, an Independent legislator backed by the ruling CPI(M), opened a can of worms for the Pinarayi Vijayan regime in a series of press conferences between Aug. 30 and Sept. 1



The key allegations are against ADGP **M.R. Ajith Kumar,** who has emerged as a 'supercop' since being given the law & order charge in 2022, and his purported aide, SP Sujith Das

The ADGP has been accused of links to gold **smuggling rackets and criminal syndicates** and of illegally acquiring wealth. Ajith Kumar vehemently denies it



Anvar has also accused Pinarayi's political secretary **P. Sasi,** who handles the home department on his behalf, of shielding corrupt cops, thus casting suspicion on the CMO as well

While SP Das has been shunted out, **Pinarayi has ordered an inquiry** by a five-member team led by the DGP. It has been given one month to submit its report

IT TOOK PINARAYI THREE DAYS TO REACT AND ORDER A HIGH-LEVEL INQUIRY EVEN AS LEADERS WITHIN BOTH THE RULING COALITION AND THE OPPOSITION MOUNTED PRESSURE ON HIM

damning allegations. According to the MLA, both Kumar and Das were hand in glove and allegedly running an extensive racket to pocket gold seized from smugglers arriving from the Middle East at the Kozhikode airport.

Anvar even accused ADGP Kumar of tapping the phone calls of politicians and key officials, including the CM. Hinting that it was the CM's political secretary and senior CPI(M) leader P. Sasi who had given Kumar unbridled powers, Anvar said he had failed to fulfil his responsibilities.

Policing the police

Responding to the gathering storm, Vijayan on September 2 promised a thorough investigation into the allegations. He made this announcement while addressing the police force at the Kerala Police Association's annual convention in Kottayam. Without naming any officer, the CM said that discipline was of utmost importance, and any violation would not be tolerated. "Action will be taken accordingly," he said. The state police chief, DGP Shaik Darvesh Saheb, and Kumar were present on the stage at the time.

Das was swiftly transferred the same day, without any fresh posting, and told to report to the DGP's office. Sources say he faces certain suspension as he had committed grave misconduct when he pleaded with the legislator not to lodge complaints against him. Pinarayi also constituted a five-member team headed by the DGP to investigate all allegations made by Anvar and file a report within